

enthusiasm and enterprise-level innovation.

The emergence of agentic AI systems—where humans and machines co-pilot complex workflows—is expected to be another game changer.

The Bond report highlights how GenAI is driving double-digit productivity gains in the West. Consider Bank of America, whose AI-powered chatbot Erica serves over 40 million clients by offering real-time insights, bill reminders, budgeting assistance, and transaction alerts. Or Yum! Brands—the parent company of KFC, Taco Bell, and Pizza Hut—which has deployed AI to streamline restaurant operations by automating routine tasks such as inventory tracking, staff scheduling, and food preparation alerts.

Large companies in the US are integrating AI into business infrastructure, often enabling strategic decision-making and large-scale efficiencies. In contrast, India's AI adoption, while enthusiastic, remains superficial for most enterprises.

Shekhar Kirani, Partner at venture capital firm Accel, believes the problem lies in Indian companies' aversion to risk. In a conversation with *BT*, he explains that Indian firms are hesitant to back AI start-ups unless they have proven themselves in the Bay Area, in the US. "Our entrepreneurs are building innovative use cases," says Kirani. "But Indian companies want validation from the Bay Area before trusting homegrown solutions."

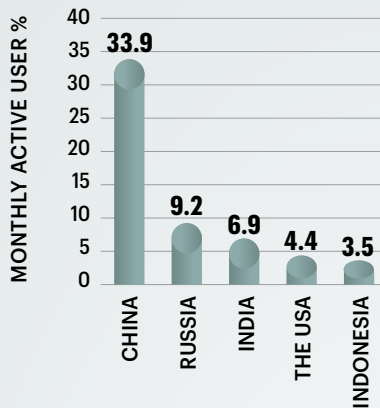
Nitin Mittal, Independent Advisor to Samsung R&D Institute, says there's no doubt that India is a talent powerhouse. "But we lack risk capital and deeptech infrastructure to support foundational R&D," says Mittal, who also served as Head of Technology Services at UIDAI.

The real gap, according to Mittal, lies in hardware design and development, where India continues to de-

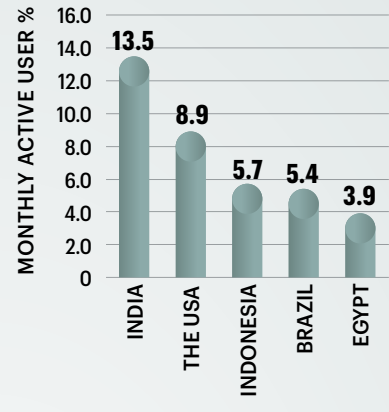
LEADING IN CONSUMPTION

India is the biggest user market for ChatGPT

DEEPSEEK



CHAT GPT



NOTE THE DATA IS FOR CHATGPT MOBILE APP MONTHLY ACTIVE USERS IN TOP 10 COUNTRIES; **SOURCE** BOND REPORT

What's happening to AI in India?

► India has the highest number of ChatGPT users, followed by the US. However, this consumer dominance hasn't translated into foundational tech development

► Most AI use cases in Indian enterprises are still focused on automation, especially in customer service and operations

► Indian firms are hesitant to adopt solutions from domestic AI start-ups unless validated by global markets, creating a barrier for homegrown innovation

► Experts stress the need for organisations to shift from a "know-it-all" to a "learn-it-all" mindset

► Most Indian firms prefer to buy ready-made GenAI tools, which accelerates adoption but limits innovation, scalability and differentiation



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